

is the only method we have to call on the binding class, and the respective instance would be bound to the UI.

6. Getting started with Google Play Services

Google Play Services is a platform that gives you, the developers, the freedom to integrate the newest and the most powerful features such as Maps, Google+ etc. within your own App with automatic platform updates distributed as an APK through the Google Play store. You can access the interfaces to the individual Google services and also obtain authorisation from users to gain access to these services with their credentials through the Google Play services client library.

Firstly, you need to setup the project with Google Play services SDK to develop an app using the Google Play services APIs. This can be done through the Android SDK Manager which you have configured in the previous chapters.

To test an app when using the Google Play services SDK it is recommendable to use an Android device that runs Android 2.3 or higher and includes Google Play Store.

To use Google Play services APIs available to your app:

1. Open the **build.gradle** file located inside the application module directory.
2. Add a new build rule under the dependencies section to integrate the latest version of play-services.

```
apply plugin: 'com.android.application'
...
dependencies [
    // To compile the entire package of APIs into your app
    compile 'com.google.android.gms:play-services:8.4.0'
    // To compile the selective package of APIs into your app
    compile 'com.google.android.gms:play-services-plus:8.4.0'
    compile 'com.google.android.gms:play-services-maps:8.4.0'
]
```

You will have to update this version number each time Google Play services is being updated.

3. Save the build.gradle and Sync Project with Gradle Files in the toolbar.

The next step would be to access the Google APIs through your application. To access the different Google APIs included in the Google Play services